

of unwanted paper. Most of the paper is perfectly fine, clean, and has only been printed on one side. This type of paper is perfect for printing online coupons and it is completely free.

#### 4. Get free hardware

In most offices there are old computer parts that are unwanted. For example, my mom's work computer broke so they purchased a new workstation for her. The old computer's LCD panel, keyboard, and mouse were all still working but they were no longer needed. She asked if she could bring those parts home and her workplace said yes. I was able to replace my old CRT with the LCD panel for free.

It generally costs money to recycle or dispose of electronics, so you may be able to pick up some perfectly good computer parts for free at the IT department. It never hurts to ask.

#### 5. Charge all your electronics at work

This may not save you that much money, but charging something at work does not increase your electricity bill. You can charge your phone, MP3 player, portable gaming device, and even rechargeable batteries. I think charging some small items at work is perfectly acceptable, but

please do not go crazy with this idea and charge your electric car at work.

If you take advantage of these unwritten benefits at work, you can save hundreds to thousands of dollars a year. Along the way you would have reduced waste and reused unwanted things so everyone comes out a winner. — **Xin Lu**

## 9 Survival Tips from Depression-Era Kids

My parents and my husband's parents were children during the Great Depression. Mine lived in large cities; my in-laws, in small towns. Their families started this era from neither a position of wealth nor desperation. Just to add perspective, though, I'll mention that their parents wouldn't have considered lack of indoor plumbing a sign of poverty, at least in their early years. Here are the basics of how they managed to survive using tactics that are still viable today.